

New & Notable

Canon Digital IXUS i zoom

Stunningly Slim

The Canon IXUS is an ultra-compact digicam available in four funky colours. It's big on features, incorporating a 5-megapixel sensor, 2.4x optical / 4x digital zoom, integrated flash, and auto-focus. It features 16 shooting modes, PictBridge, and a one-touch print/share button. Video recording is possible at 640 x 480 at up to 10 fps. The excellent 1.8-inch TFT is crystal-clear, the interface is intuitive and the photographs crisp.

The IXUS features a docking station that works as a charger for the inbuilt Lithium-ion battery, and also connects to the PC via USB 2.0. The inbuilt flash is good enough, but the effective range is only about two metres. Shutter lag makes shooting moving objects a problem.

The IXUS has no internal memory, and comes with a paltry 16 MB MMC card. We recommend at least 256 MB, so add that to the camera's price if you want to buy it.



Company **Canon India Ltd**
Price **Rs 25,495**
Phone **0124-4160000**
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Web site www.canon.co.in

Rating



Canon IXUS 750

Pricey Shots

"A large feature set and an even larger price tag" best describes the Canon IXUS 750. Catering to the semi-professional and the indulgent enthusiast classes of photographers, this 7.1-megapixel camera sports a superb 2.5-inch screen.

Zoom is the standard optical 3x and digital 4x. Shoot modes include: nine scene, auto focus, three white balancing, portrait and night. Other features include USB 2.0, customisable power saving options and themes, warning of camera shake probability, and many more goodies that can really put a smile on your face!

The images we shot were rich and clear, and the video is VGA at 30 fps with mono sound or at 60 fps and 320 x 240.

Excellent camera, no doubt, but the smile ends as soon as you hear the price—Rs 29,995!



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Price (estimated) : **Rs 29,995**
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JVC Everio GZ-MG20e

No More Tape!

The JVC Everio GZ-MG20e DV cam comes with a 20 GB hard drive that promises to make tape media obsolete. This camera is amazingly light—just 380 grams.

The camera has no viewfinder: you have to rely on the 2.5 inch, 180-degree-swivel colour LCD. The downside to this is that shooting with high ambient light is a problem.

There are four recording modes: you can record up to seven hours of video in Fine mode and up to 24 hours in Eco mode, thus ensuring you won't miss a moment of your vacation. Since you record to a hard drive, you can easily delete unwanted scenes and rearrange the footage on the go!

The 25x optical zoom is more than enough for any occasion. But despite the superb image stabilising mechanism, you will require a tripod to shoot video at that magnification. The Tele Macro feature allows you to shoot from as close as 5 cm.



Company **MCC Group**
Price **Rs 46,900**
Phone **011-26102975**
E-mail mccops@vsnl.net
Web site www.jvc.com

Rating



Using the AV input, the Everio turns into a VCR, allowing you to connect to older analogue sources and convert your old memories to digital format. Computer connectivity is via USB 2.0. The camera is also a VGA digital still camera. Photos can be stored either on the hard drive or on an SD card using the SD card slot. The PictBridge and DPOF standards are also supported. An S-Video out is provided to view captured video on a TV in normal or 16:10 aspect ratio, and this is made easy by the accompanying remote.

We found the capture quality as good as that of any other DV cam. The GZ-MG20e comes with CyberLink's video editing suite, which complements the camera perfectly. But you've got to remember that the package costs Rs 46,900. Even then, this being possibly the first hard drive-based camera for home use, you can stop worrying about running out of tape!

